Helix Constitution

Field	Value
Revision	5
Created	2026-05-14
Last modified	2026-10-05T09:58:19Z
Status	active
Status summary	Universal engineering constitution shared by every project that includes this repository as a Git submodule. R5 refresh (2026-10-05 — closing a ~49-anchor staleness gap the prior R4 blurb had accumulated since 2026-07-23): the anchor corpus now extends through §11.4.276 (§11.4.276 review-round budget — every independently-reviewed work item converges within a declared budget of at most 7 rounds, landed 2026-10-05 off a direct operator CRITICAL mandate about excessive review-round counts; §11.4.268–§11.4.271 the speckit 002-anti-slop-enforcement tamper-evident-evidence / critic-advisory-only / dependency-existence-verdict / waiver-mechanism quartet; §11.4.257–§11.4.267 the 2026-08-15/2026-08-20 enterprise-quality + AI-curriculum harvest rounds; §11.4.230–§11.4.254 the parallelized-pipeline, nano-precision model-tier, anti-mess orchestration, and critical-invariant/producer-verifier-separation families) plus the §12.11/§12.12 host-safety axes, with governance mirrored in lockstep across CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md / QWEN.md / GEMINI.md (§11.4.157); the authoritative per-round history lives in Constitution.md's own header Status summary — this README's own summary is a point-in-time pointer to that history, not a substitute for it, and is expected to go stale again between refreshes (consult Constitution.md's header for the true current state). The prior R4 blurb (anchor corpus "now extends through §11.4.227", written 2026-07-23) had itself gone stale by roughly 49 anchors before this refresh — the same staleness pattern R4 had flagged in its own predecessor (the R2 blurb, stale by ~150 anchors) recurring one cycle later; readers of this file should treat the Constitution.md header as authoritative whenever the two could plausibly have drifted.

Field	Value
Issues	none
Issues sum-mary	—
Fixed	initial creation (R1, 2026-05-14); README overhaul + recent-additions refresh (R2, 2026-05-20); revision-header + recent-anchor-coverage re-fresh (R3, 2026-07-23 — review Minor M3 of commit 698dd52); revision-header + recent-anchor-coverage refresh (R4, 2026-07-23 — the §11.4.226/§11.4.227 reopen-root-cause-harvest round); revision-header + recent-anchor-coverage refresh (R5, 2026-10-05 — closing the §11.4.227→§11.4.276 staleness gap).
Fixed sum-mary	—
Con-tinu-ation	—

> The universal engineering constitution shared by every project that includes this repository as a Git submodule.

What this is

This repository contains the **universal, project-agnostic** rules, constraints, and conventions that every Helix project (and any other project that opts in) inherits automatically. Project-specific rules live in the consuming project's own `Constitution.md` / `CLAUDE.md` / `AGENTS.md` / `QWEN.md` and **extend** what is in here.

The model is three-layer (top-to-bottom evaluation, project overrides universal when conflicts are explicit):

1. **Base layer (this submodule)** — universal rules: anti-bluff covenant (§11.4), data safety, host safety, test coverage, commit/ push discipline, credentials handling (§11.4.10), documentation discipline (§11.4.65), submodule-catalogue-first discovery (§11.4.74), containers-submodule mandate (§11.4.76).
2. **Project layer** — project root `Constitution.md` / `CLAUDE.md` / `AGENTS.md` / `QWEN.md` : domain-specific rules, hardware-specific constraints, service-specific configuration.
3. **Subdirectory layer (optional)** — `<subdir>/CLAUDE.md` for module-local overrides. CLI agents (Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, OpenCode, Qwen Code, Kimi CLI, Crush) merge these by walking up from the working directory.

[1]

How to consume

. Add the submodule

In each consuming project:

```
git submodule add git@github.com:HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution.git constitution

# Pin to a tag for reproducibility (recommended)
cd constitution
git checkout v1.0.0          # whatever the current stable tag is
cd ..
git add constitution
git commit -m "chore: add Helix Constitution submodule pinned to v1.0.0"
```

When teammates clone your project:

```
git clone --recurse-submodules <your-project-url>
# or if already cloned:
git submodule update --init --recursive
```

. Wire the inheritance

Add a clearly-marked pointer at the top of your project's root `CLAUDE.md`:

```
## INHERITED FROM constitution/CLAUDE.md

All rules in `constitution/CLAUDE.md` (and the `constitution/Constitution.md`
it references) apply unconditionally. Project-specific rules below
extend them.

@constitution/CLAUDE.md
```

Same for `AGENTS.md` (any AI-agent tooling) and (since 2026-05-20) `QWEN.md` for Qwen Code:

```
> Base agent rules: `constitution/AGENTS.md` — READ IT FIRST.
> The base file is authoritative for any topic not covered here.
```

And for your project Constitution:

```
This constitution **extends** the Helix Universal Constitution at
`constitution/Constitution.md`. All clauses there apply unless
explicitly overridden below with an explicit `Override §X.Y`
section.
```

. Set up the multi-upstream push

From the **constitution submodule's** root directory:

```
cd constitution
bash install_upstreams.sh
```

This reads every `Upstreams/*.sh` declaration and configures matching git remotes locally, so a single `git push` reaches every provider (GitHub, GitLab, GitFlic, GitVerse).

Alternatively, if your toolkit ships the system-wide `install_upstreams` command (Project-Toolkit `Upstreamable/`), you can invoke that instead — it reads the same `Upstreams/` directory.

. Verify inheritance with an automated test

Every consuming project should ship a test that verifies the constitution submodule is present, at the expected pinned revision, and that the project's CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md / QWEN.md / Constitution all reference the submodule. See:

- The ATMOSphere project's `test_constitution_inheritance.sh` for the reference implementation pattern.
- The Herald project's `tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh` + paired `tests/test_i6_refinement_meta.sh` for an example with refined I6 invariant (allows non-constitution submodules) per the original pattern.
- The Herald `scripts/audit_antibluff.sh` for the canonical anti-bluff audit pattern (3 invariants: §11.4 anchor across submodules + default test suite green + paired §1.1 meta-test green).

Contents

File	Purpose
`Constitution.md`	**The canonical universal constitution.** All clauses are project-agnostic.
`CLAUDE.md`	Universal CLAUDE.md for Claude Code agents. Imports `Constitution.md` by reference.
`AGENTS.md`	Universal AGENTS.md for every other CLI agent (Codex, Cursor, Aider, OpenCode, Crush, Kimi CLI).
`QWEN.md`	Universal QWEN.md for the Qwen Code CLI agent. Created 2026-05-20 per the §11.4.76 propagation set.
`submodules-catalogue.md`	Canonical inventory of every owned-by-us repository under `vasic-digital` + `HelixDevelopment` (142 repos at landing time). Created 2026-05-20 per §11.4.74 follow-up mandate.
`LICENSE`	License governing the constitution text itself.
`Upstreams/`	One `.sh` declaration file per upstream Git remote.
`install_upstreams.sh`	Configures every declared upstream as a local git remote.
`find_constitution.sh`	Helper that locates this submodule from arbitrary nested depth.
`meta_test_inheritance.sh`	Sentinel-based meta-test that verifies the inheritance gate catches a deletion of the §11.4 anchor.
`templates/`	Templates for project-specific Constitution / CLAUDE / AGENTS / QWEN files.

Recent additions (- -)

The following clauses + companion files landed this session in response to operator mandates. Each entry includes the verbatim user mandate in its forensic-anchor block within `Constitution.md`:

Clause	Topic
§11.4.73	Main-specification document versioning + Revision discipline (V1/V2/V3 primary + Revision secondary axes).
§11.4.74	Submodule-catalogue-first discovery + extend-don't-reimplement. See `submodules-catalogue.md`.
§11.4.75	Mechanical enforcement without exception (5-layer git-hook discipline).
§11.4.76	Containers-submodule mandate — use `vasic-digital/containers` for ALL containerised workloads.
§11.4.77	Regeneration-mechanism-required mandate.
§11.4.78	CodeGraph code-intelligence mandate (npm `@colbymchenry/codegraph`).

New companion file: `submodules-catalogue.md` — 142 repos categorised into 10 capability groups (Container + lifecycle, AI/LLM + agent, Messaging + observability + storage, Auth + security + middleware, Cross-platform KMP, TypeScript/React + Web, Testing + QA, Apps/tools, Misc/scaffolds).

New file: `QWEN.md` — Qwen Code CLI agent's view of the universal constitution, structured analogously to `AGENTS.md` but tailored to Qwen Code's expectations.

Multi-upstream topology

This repository is hosted on four providers, with GitHub as the primary:

Remote	URL
`github` (primary)	`git@github.com:HelixDevelopment/HelixConstitution.git`
`gitlab`	`git@gitlab.com:helixdevelopment1/helixconstitution.git`
`gitflic`	`git@gitflic.ru:helixdevelopment/helixconstitution.git`
`gitverse`	`git@gitverse.ru:helixdevelopment/HelixConstitution.git`

Every commit MUST be pushed to ALL four. The `origin` remote is configured with multiple push URLs so `git push origin <branch>` fans out to every provider in one command.

Recursive inheritance

Between the consuming project's root and any submodule that uses this constitution there may be N intermediate levels. The `find_constitution.sh` helper walks up parents until it locates the constitution submodule, so nested submodules can source the helper without knowing their own depth.

Versioning

Tag the constitution at semantically meaningful checkpoints (`v1.0.0` , `v1.1.0` , `v2.0.0`). Consuming projects pin to a specific tag and upgrade deliberately. Major version bumps mean breaking changes to the universal rules; minor bumps mean additions; patches mean clarifications.

Per the new §11.4.73 spec-versioning discipline (added 2026-05-20), consuming projects that maintain a main specification document follow the **two-axis** rule: primary V for major rewrites, secondary `Revision N` (in metadata table) for additive changes within a primary version.

Contributing

Universal status has to be **earned**, not assumed. Project-specific content does NOT belong here. When in doubt, classify a rule as project-specific and keep it in the consuming project's own Constitution.

A rule is **universal** only if ALL are true:

1. It would be true for at least 3 unrelated projects across different domains.
2. It does not reference a specific service / schema / port / topic / table / vendor / hardware unique to one project.
3. It encodes a *policy* or *principle*, not a *configuration value*.
4. Removing it from any consuming project would be just as wrong as removing it from any other.

A rule is **project-specific** if any are true:

- Mentions a specific service, package, topic, table, ML model, protocol version, hardware, or vendor.
- Encodes a numeric threshold tuned for one codebase (coverage %, latency SLOs, retry counts).
- Describes a workaround for a bug or quirk in a dependency this project uses.

License

See `LICENSE`.